OVERVIEW TOOL | NOT A FINAL EXAM PAPER | CHOICES REMAIN OPEN

Coop Denmark, Coop App and Lobyco: possible analytical angles

This report maps possible directions for an IT-strategy exam paper. It keeps the executive, theory choice and strategic position open, and treats marketing and supplier sources as useful but cautious evidence.

Executive Summary

PURPOSE

Create choice material before selecting one final paper direction.

STRONG RECURRING PATTERN

Coop App reach may matter, but strategic value depends on fit with stores, chain positioning, supplier value and financial discipline.

MAIN CAUTION

Adoption, engagement and campaign claims support possible digital value, but not necessarily profitability.

Table Of Contents

Each actor section contains three possible angles. The angle cards are deliberately comparative rather than decisive.

Strongest Angles comparison

Open Decisions next choices

Source Foundation

The project folder identifies five actual supplementary source files. These are used as the starting source package, with competitor scraping and internal evidence files used only as supporting project synthesis.

SOURCE KEY	ACTUAL LOCATED SOURCE	USE IN THIS OVERVIEW	MAIN SOURCE CRITICISM
S1	Exam/case material: *Digital transformation for den moderne detailkæde | Coop*	Factual case foundation for Coop, Coop App, Lobyco, store model and financial pressure.	Low bias as exam material, but exact wording and numbers must be checked before final writing.
S2	DVC Framework: *TEBR_MarApr_DVC Framework (Final)*	Course theory for digital value creation, customer experience, relationships, relevance and digital outputs.	Can make digital value sound too positive if not balanced with business model and source criticism.
S3	Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen 2016: *The Challenge of...*	Historical context for Coop IT complexity, legacy and transformation path.	Older source; use for historical patterns, not as evidence for current performance.
S4	Lobyco source: *Helping 25% of Danish households shop smarter*	Claims about Coop App reach, engagement, loyalty and Lobyco value logic.	Commercially interested subsidiary/marketing source; not neutral proof of profitability.
S5	Supplier/marketing source: *How Coop fueled loyalty and retail media | Playable*	Claims about gamification, campaigns, engagement and retail media value.	Supplier marketing; useful for intended value logic, weak as causal or financial evidence.

Shortcut is mentioned in the project evidence register as a possible developer/marketing source, but it is not one of the five located PDF files in the supplementary source folder. Treat Shortcut as source missing/unverified unless separately located.

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1. CEO / Top Management

This actor makes the paper about strategic allocation: how Coop should balance financial pressure, digital capability, chain complexity and the long-term role of Lobyco.

Best when the paper needs a broad turnaround perspective. Main risk: the analysis can become too wide unless the final recommendation logic is tightly governed.

CEO Angle A: Keep App/Lobyco, But Govern It Through Store Economics

Strategic question: Should Coop keep Coop App and Lobyco as strategic assets only if they improve store-based economics?

MEDIUM-LOW EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Coop should not judge the app as a standalone digital success; the CEO should govern further investment through store traffic, basket effects, chain relevance, retail media discipline and contribution to financial recovery.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Exam evidence indicates Coop is financially pressured and currently store-based after coop.dk closure.
- Lobyco claims app reach and engagement, suggesting potential digital infrastructure.
- Competitor evidence suggests digital tools are strongest when fitted to business model and operations.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- App adoption does not prove profitability.

- Strict financial governance may underinvest in capabilities whose value appears over time.
- Competitor evidence is a project synthesis and needs source-level verification.

THEORY APPLICATION

DVC digital outputs -> Coop has app engagement claims -> outputs are not outcomes -> CEO should distinguish engagement KPIs from store and profit KPIs. Digital Business Model value capture -> Coop is store-based -> app value must be captured through stores, suppliers or loyalty -> investment should depend on business-model fit.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Create an executive app/Lobyco governance board; approve features through store-economics KPIs; stop or redesign app activities with weak chain/customer contribution.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Store-level app-user basket data, campaign profitability, retail media revenue, Lobyco cost base, chain-by-chain app contribution and internal KPI definitions.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for financial pressure, coop.dk closure and store model.

Used: S2 DVC for digital outputs and customer value logic.

Used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen for historical IT capability/complexity context.

Used: S4 Lobyco for claimed app reach and capability value.

Used: S5 Playable for claimed campaign and retail media value, treated cautiously.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

The angle is relatively robust because it combines official case facts with cautious use of marketing claims. It must avoid implying that engagement metrics equal profitability.

CEO Angle B: Digital Portfolio Discipline Under Turnaround Pressure

Strategic question: Which digital initiatives should Coop scale, maintain, reduce or stop during financial pressure?

MEDIUM EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

The CEO should treat Coop App, Lobyco, retail media and gamified campaigns as a digital investment portfolio where each initiative must justify its role in the turnaround.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Exam material indicates structural financial pressure and revenue/loss concerns.
- Project evidence warns against weak causality from app adoption to profitability.
- Competitors show different digital tools tied to different operating models.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- A portfolio lens may become finance-heavy and understate customer relationship value.
- Lobyco could be a strategic capability that is hard to rebuild if reduced too aggressively.
- External platform potential is not yet verified.

THEORY APPLICATION

Digital Business Model resources -> Lobyco/app may be a key resource -> resource value depends on value creation and capture -> CEO should classify digital assets by strategic and economic contribution. Implementation perspective -> Coop faces execution constraints -> broad digital ambition can fail without governance -> prioritize fewer, measurable initiatives.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Introduce scale/hold/reduce/exit decisions for digital initiatives; require benefit owners; link retail media and campaign work to documented commercial results.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Initiative costs, benefits, dependency map, data/technology ownership, alternative investment needs and management capacity.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for turnaround pressure.

Not used: S2 DVC - reason: the portfolio lens is mainly economic/governance oriented.

Used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen for historical IT transformation complexity.

Used: S4 Lobyco for claimed digital capability and app value.

Used: S5 Playable for campaign/retail media claims as portfolio candidates.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

Lobyco and Playable should be read as evidence of possible value areas, not proof that those areas deserve investment priority.

CEO Angle C: Clarify Whether Lobyco Is Core Capability, Support Unit Or Divestment Candidate

Strategic question: Should Lobyco primarily serve Coop's stores, grow externally, or be reconsidered as an ownership asset?

HIGH EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Top management should clarify Lobyco's mandate before making further app strategy choices because the right governance differs if Lobyco is a Coop support capability, a growth platform or a potential divestment asset.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Case/project evidence indicates Coop App was separated into Lobyco.
- Lobyco source claims substantial app reach and value logic.
- Retail media and supplier-funded value suggest possible platform logic.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- Evidence for external growth or sale value may be thin.
- The exam case may be more about Coop Denmark than Lobyco as a separate company.

- Divestment claims would require valuation evidence not currently present.

THEORY APPLICATION

Platform/ecosystem perspective -> Lobyco may connect Coop, app users and suppliers -> this could create multi-sided value -> CEO should test whether platform language is empirically warranted. Resource-based view -> Lobyco may be a digital capability -> it is strategic only if valuable, rare and hard to imitate -> ownership decision needs capability evidence.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Run a mandate review: define Lobyco's primary customer, required financial targets, external growth ambition and dependency on Coop data/stores.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Lobyco revenue split, external clients, profitability, ownership structure, data rights, valuation and alternatives to in-house capability.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for Lobyco/Coop relationship.

Not used: S2 DVC - reason: the central issue is ownership and platform mandate rather than customer-value mechanics.

Used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen for IT capability and legacy context.

Used: S4 Lobyco for self-presentation of app and capability value.

Used: S5 Playable for supplier/campaign value that could support ecosystem logic.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

This angle is analytically interesting but evidence-hungry. It should not recommend sale, spin-out or platform scaling without stronger financial and ownership data.

2. Director Of Communication, Marketing And Digital

This actor makes the paper about customer relationship, loyalty, communication, app relevance and retail media, while still requiring financial and store-level discipline.

This is the strongest fit if the final paper should stay close to Coop App and Lobyco without becoming either finance-only or technology-only.

Digital Angle A: From App Reach To Customer Relevance

Strategic question: How can Coop turn app adoption into relevant, store-linked customer value?

MEDIUM-LOW EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

The Director should shift the app logic from reach and engagement toward relevance: savings, convenience, inspiration and store support that differ by customer mission and chain.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Lobyco claims Coop App has substantial user reach and engagement.
- DVC supports analysing experiences, relationships and relevance.
- Competitor evidence suggests Lidl, Salling and Dagrofa/MENY connect app value to specific customer promises.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- High reach may reflect existing loyal customers rather than conversion or profitable growth.
- Personalization and retail media may create trust risks if too commercial.
- Coop needs internal evidence that relevance changes behaviour.

THEORY APPLICATION

DVC relevance -> Coop has multiple chains and customer missions -> one app logic may create uneven value -> tailor digital value by chain and shopping situation. DVC relationships -> Coop App enables repeated contact -> relationship value is only strategic if it changes store behaviour or loyalty -> measure outcomes beyond opens and clicks.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Develop chain-specific app value propositions; replace generic engagement targets with customer relevance and store-behaviour KPIs.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Segmented app-user behaviour, chain-specific feature use, churn/retention data, customer trust feedback and store conversion effects.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for Coop App and physical-store context.

Used: S2 DVC for relevance, relationships and experiences.

Not used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen - reason: historical IT context is secondary to customer relevance.

Used: S4 Lobyco for app reach and engagement claims.

Used: S5 Playable for engagement/campaign claims, treated cautiously.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

The app source claims support possible reach and engagement, but the argument must state that relevance and profitability remain unproven without internal data.

Digital Angle B: Retail Media With Trust And KPI Discipline

Strategic question: Can Coop use app data and supplier campaigns without weakening customer trust or overclaiming financial value?

MEDIUM EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Retail media could be a valuable extension of Coop App/Lobyco, but it should be governed as a trust-sensitive business model, not as simple advertising inventory.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Lobyco and Playable sources indicate retail media and campaign engagement possibilities.

- Platform/ecosystem theory can frame interactions among Coop, customers and suppliers.
- Financial pressure makes supplier-funded value strategically attractive.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- Supplier sources are commercially interested.
- Campaign engagement may not produce long-term loyalty or profit.
- Too much supplier influence could reduce perceived customer relevance.

THEORY APPLICATION

Platform/ecosystem actors -> Coop, app users and suppliers interact through the app -> retail media may create multi-sided value -> strategic implication is governance of incentives and trust. Digital Business Model value capture -> supplier-funded campaigns can create revenue -> value capture must not damage customer value -> set limits and transparency rules.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Define retail media principles, supplier campaign acceptance criteria, customer-value thresholds and measurement separating campaign engagement from incremental sales.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Supplier revenue, incremental sales, customer opt-out/complaint data, campaign attribution method and trust/privacy governance.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for Coop/Lobyco strategic setting.

Not used: S2 DVC - reason: platform and business model logic are more central here.

Not used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen - reason: historical IT context does not directly evidence retail media.

Used: S4 Lobyco for retail media/app value claims.

Used: S5 Playable for supplier campaign and loyalty claims.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

This angle has strong marketing-source bias. It is usable if framed as a possible value logic requiring verification, not as proof of supplier-funded profitability.

Digital Angle C: One Coop App, Many Chain Promises

Strategic question: Should Coop communicate one shared app identity or tailor app communication to each chain?

MEDIUM EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Coop should avoid a one-size-fits-all app story and instead make the app express different chain promises: savings for discount, inspiration for food-led stores and convenience for local shopping.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Competitor synthesis suggests Lidl Plus reinforces discount, MENY reinforces food/local identity and Salling integrates store utilities.
- DVC relevance fits the need for different digital value propositions.
- Coop's store-based model makes chain-level fit important.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- Too much differentiation may fragment the app and increase complexity.
- Requires evidence that Coop chain customers actually want different digital experiences.
- The paper may drift into general brand strategy if not anchored in app/Lobyco.

THEORY APPLICATION

DVC relevance -> different chain missions imply different definitions of useful digital value -> generic engagement may be weak -> tailor app journeys. Porter/positioning -> digital tools can reinforce competitive positioning -> Coop observation is chain diversity -> strategic implication is app communication aligned with chain promise.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Create a chain-specific app communication matrix; define a few shared platform functions plus differentiated offer, content and campaign logic.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Coop chain strategy documents, customer segments, app feature use by chain, competitor feature verification and brand perception data.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for chain and store context.

Used: S2 DVC for relevance and customer experience.

Not used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen - reason: current chain positioning is more relevant than historical IT context.

Used: S4 Lobyco for shared app reach and capability claims.

Used: S5 Playable for campaign engagement possibilities.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

Competitor evidence supports the pattern but remains secondary until exact source URLs and wording are transferred into the reference system.

3. CFO / Finance Leadership

This actor makes the paper skeptical and investment-focused: how should Coop justify, measure and possibly limit digital spending under financial pressure?

Best when the paper wants strong source criticism and investment discipline. Main risk: underplaying the course's digital value creation perspective.

CFO Angle A: From Engagement KPIs To Economic KPIs

Strategic question: Which financial and operating KPIs should decide whether Coop App and Lobyco deserve continued investment?

MEDIUM-LOW EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

The CFO should replace success language based on app adoption and engagement with a KPI hierarchy linking app use to incremental store value, supplier revenue, cost reduction and customer retention.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Financial pressure is documented in the exam/project evidence.
- Source criticism warns that app engagement does not prove profitability.
- Competitor evidence shows profitable competitors use digital tools as operationally fitted utilities.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- Some strategic digital value is indirect and difficult to attribute.
- Overly strict short-term KPIs may cut learning and capability development.
- Internal data access may be unavailable for an exam paper.

THEORY APPLICATION

Digital Business Model value capture -> app creates value only if Coop captures it economically -> current evidence mainly shows claimed reach -> strategic implication is a KPI bridge from activity to outcomes. Implementation perspective -> measurement discipline shapes execution -> unclear KPIs create diffuse investment -> define owner, metric and decision rule.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Build a digital value scorecard separating reach, behaviour, incremental sales, margin, supplier revenue and cost-to-serve.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

App P&L, Lobyco P&L, campaign attribution, app-user/non-user comparison, incremental margin and retention economics.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for financial pressure.

Not used: S2 DVC - reason: KPI design is primarily financial/business model oriented.

Not used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen - reason: historical IT context is not central to KPI choice.

Used: S4 Lobyco for adoption and engagement claims that need financial testing.

Used: S5 Playable for campaign engagement claims that need attribution testing.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

This angle explicitly uses marketing claims as claims to test. It should avoid claiming that missing evidence means the app has no value.

CFO Angle B: Investment Thresholds For App, Retail Media And Lobyco

Strategic question: What investment thresholds should Coop apply to future digital initiatives?

MEDIUM EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Coop should continue digital investment only where the initiative has a clear value owner, measurable outcome and credible path to financial contribution.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Coop's weak result context increases the opportunity cost of digital investment.
- Playable/Lobyco claims indicate multiple possible value paths: loyalty, campaigns, retail media.
- Competitor evidence suggests fit matters more than feature breadth.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- Thresholds may push Coop toward incrementalism and away from strategic digital capability.
- Some initiatives may be necessary hygiene factors even if direct ROI is modest.
- Evidence on costs and benefits may be confidential.

THEORY APPLICATION

Digital Business Model value proposition/value capture -> initiatives must connect customer value and capture logic -> Coop's evidence is uneven -> implication is staged funding. Implementation perspective -> governance under constraints -> Coop should use pilots, gates and stop rules -> avoid broad scaling before evidence.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Use stage-gate funding for app features and retail media; require pre-defined hypotheses and post-campaign benefit review.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Feature backlog, development cost, campaign ROI, supplier willingness to pay, customer data permissions and operational constraints in stores.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for financial pressure and digital context.

Not used: S2 DVC - reason: the angle is about investment governance rather than customer-value mapping.

Used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen for historical transformation complexity and implementation caution.

Used: S4 Lobyco for possible value claims to test.

Used: S5 Playable for campaign value claims to test.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

The argument must separate financial facts from managerial recommendations. Investment thresholds are an analytical proposal, not a fact found in the sources.

CFO Angle C: A Skeptical Case For Reducing App-Centric Ambition

Strategic question: Should Coop reduce broad app ambition and focus digital spending on fewer store-critical functions?

HIGH EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Given financial pressure and uncertain causality, Coop should reduce app-centric ambition unless features demonstrably support store economics or supplier-funded value.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- App adoption and engagement are not profitability evidence.
- Coop closed coop.dk due to lack of profitability, indicating digital channels can fail economically.
- REMA/Lidl evidence suggests price, simplicity and store promise may matter more than app sophistication.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- The app may be a necessary loyalty and data channel in modern grocery.
- Lobyco may be a strategic capability that competitors cannot easily copy.
- A strongly anti-app paper may conflict with the digital-strategy course framing unless carefully argued.

THEORY APPLICATION

Digital Business Model fit -> digital value depends on operating model -> Coop's store model and losses create investment pressure -> reduce non-store-critical app work. Porter/positioning -> competitors may win through price and simplicity -> app sophistication alone is not positioning -> focus digital on reinforcing a clear customer promise.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Concentrate on essential store-linked app functions; pause speculative campaigns or features; reallocate budget to price perception, store execution or chain-specific utility.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Cost savings from reduction, app dependency in loyalty program, competitor adoption expectations and risk of losing customer data/communication capability.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for financial pressure and coop.dk closure.

Not used: S2 DVC - reason: a skeptical reduction angle relies less on positive digital value mechanisms.

Not used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen - reason: historical IT issues do not prove current app reduction is right.

Used: S4 Lobyco only as a claim source to challenge.

Used: S5 Playable only as a supplier claim source to challenge.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

This angle is useful as a counter-position but risky as final paper direction. It needs evidence that reduction would improve Coop's strategic position, not only skepticism toward marketing claims.

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4. Commercial Director / Chain Management

This actor makes the paper about whether digital tools support stores, chains, customer missions and competitive positioning in the grocery market.

Best if competitor evidence becomes central. Main risk: the paper may underplay Lobyco's broader digital business model unless the app-store link is clear.

Commercial Angle A: Differentiate App Strategy By Chain

Strategic question: Should Coop App create different value for discount, supermarket, local and food-led formats?

MEDIUM-LOW EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Coop should make Coop App a shared infrastructure with differentiated chain propositions, because different chains compete on different customer promises.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Competitor evidence shows different app roles: Lidl for savings, Salling for store utility, MENY for food/local identity.
- DVC relevance supports tailoring digital value to context.
- Coop's store-based model makes chain-level store impact central.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- Differentiation increases complexity and may weaken scale economies in the app.
- Coop chain evidence is not yet as developed as competitor evidence.
- Customers may value a simple shared app more than chain-specific variation.

THEORY APPLICATION

DVC relevance -> digital value depends on fit with customer task -> Coop chains serve different tasks -> chain-specific app logic can increase relevance. Porter/positioning -> digital tools should reinforce competitive position -> competitor pattern shows fit between app and promise -> Coop should avoid generic app positioning.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Define chain-specific app missions: savings and speed for discount, inspiration and local offers for supermarkets, convenience for local shopping.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Coop chain portfolio data, chain strategies, customer segment data, feature use by store type and competitor feature verification.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for Coop stores and chain context.

Used: S2 DVC for relevance and customer experience.

Not used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen - reason: historical IT context is less relevant than current chain fit.

Used: S4 Lobyco for shared app capability.

Used: S5 Playable for adaptable campaign mechanics.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

The argument depends heavily on competitor synthesis. It should cite original competitor source URLs later rather than only the generated scrape summary.

Commercial Angle B: The App As Store Traffic And Basket Tool

Strategic question: Can Coop App be made valuable primarily by increasing physical-store visits, basket size and shopping convenience?

MEDIUM EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Because Coop currently sells through physical stores, Coop App should be evaluated as a store-performance tool rather than a separate digital channel.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Exam material indicates coop.dk was closed due to lack of profitability and Coop is store-based.
- Salling and REMA evidence suggests Scan&Go/Scan Selv style utilities connect digital to store flow.
- DVC experiences can analyse the app as part of shopping experience.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- Store traffic and basket effects need internal data, not just app-feature descriptions.
- Digital relationship value may also matter outside immediate store visits.
- Store execution barriers could limit app impact.

THEORY APPLICATION

DVC experiences -> app functions can change the shopping journey -> Coop is store-based -> strategic implication is to prioritize features that remove friction or increase visit value. Implementation perspective -> store tools require operational fit -> app features fail if stores cannot execute -> pilot and train by format.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Prioritize store-linked features, local offer activation and friction reduction; measure store-level conversion and operational adoption.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Store visit frequency, basket lift, checkout friction data, store staff feedback and operational cost of app-enabled features.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for store-based model and coop.dk closure.

Used: S2 DVC for experiences and digital outputs.

Used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen for longer-term IT implementation context.

Used: S4 Lobyco for app capability and reach claims.

Not used: S5 Playable - reason: campaign/gamification is secondary to store-operations value.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

Feature availability is not business impact. The final paper would need internal or clearly sourced evidence linking app use to store outcomes.

Commercial Angle C: Digital Loyalty Cannot Substitute For Price And Simplicity

Strategic question: Should Coop use the app mainly to support price perception and simpler shopping rather than broad digital engagement?

MEDIUM EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Coop App should reinforce sharper price/value and simplicity signals, because discount competitors may win through clear propositions rather than broad app sophistication.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Lidl Plus is tied to coupons, member prices and purchase goals.
- REMA evidence suggests a focused discount model with narrow digital utility.
- Project source criticism warns that app engagement is not the same as customer value or profitability.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- Coop's chains are not all pure discount; a pure price app logic may fit only part of the portfolio.
- Loyalty, inspiration and retail media could still matter for other chains.
- Competitor price/value claims can be promotional or contested.

THEORY APPLICATION

Porter/positioning -> customer value depends on clear competitive position -> discount competitors signal price and simplicity -> Coop should make app value reinforce the chosen chain position. DVC relationships -> loyalty mechanisms can maintain contact -> if contact does not support price/value perception it may be weak -> design loyalty around relevant benefits.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Simplify discount-chain app experience; make savings transparent; limit gamification where it distracts from price trust.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Customer price perception, chain-specific price strategy, app offer redemption by segment, competitor price data and customer survey evidence.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for Coop's financial and competitive context.

Used: S2 DVC for relationship and relevance logic.

Not used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen - reason: current price/value competition is the main issue.

Used: S4 Lobyco for app relationship claims.

Used: S5 Playable as a campaign/gamification source to be critically evaluated.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

The angle should not overstate REMA/Lidl success from secondary or promotional sources. It is strongest as a caution against app-centric thinking.

5. Lobyco Leadership

This actor makes the paper about Lobyco's strategic role: Coop support capability, retail media platform, external product business or disciplined technology provider.

Best if the user wants a digital business model/platform paper. Main risk: drifting away from Coop Denmark's turnaround problem.

Lobyco Angle A: Lobyco As Coop's Store-Value Engine

Strategic question: Should Lobyco focus primarily on making Coop's physical stores more valuable rather than on broader platform ambitions?

MEDIUM EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Lobyco should define success by its contribution to Coop's store-based model: better customer relevance, store traffic, supplier-funded campaigns and chain-specific digital capabilities.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Exam/project evidence indicates Coop depends on physical stores after coop.dk closure.
- Lobyco claims app reach and engagement.
- DVC and business model perspectives both support linking customer value to value capture.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- A narrow Coop-support mandate may limit Lobyco's external growth potential.
- Store contribution can be hard to attribute.
- Lobyco self-claims need independent verification.

THEORY APPLICATION

DVC infrastructure -> Lobyco is digital infrastructure/capability -> capability value depends on customer and organisational value -> focus product roadmap on Coop store outcomes. Digital Business Model channels -> app is store-linked channel -> value capture happens through stores/suppliers -> measure Lobyco by economic contribution.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Create a Lobyco-Coop product charter; map each product feature to store, chain or supplier value; reduce features without clear business owner.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Lobyco roadmap, Coop stakeholder needs, store metrics, product cost allocation and external-client opportunity cost.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

- **Used:** S1 Exam/case material for Coop/Lobyco context.
- **Used:** S2 DVC for infrastructure and customer value.
- **Used:** S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen for capability and IT transformation history.
- **Used:** S4 Lobyco for app reach and product-value claims.
- **Used:** S5 Playable for campaign/retail media value claims.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

The angle is defensible if Lobyco is not allowed to mark its own homework. Success claims need Coop-side operating and financial evidence.

Lobyco Angle B: Retail Media And Supplier Ecosystem

Strategic question: Can Lobyco become a responsible platform connecting Coop, customers and suppliers?

HIGH EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Lobyco may become strategically valuable if it develops a trust-sensitive retail media ecosystem where suppliers fund relevant customer value rather than intrusive advertising.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Lobyco and Playable sources indicate retail media and campaign engagement logic.
- Platform/ecosystem theory fits supplier-customer-store interactions.
- Financial pressure makes non-traditional value capture attractive.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- Platform evidence is likely thin and marketing-driven.
- Coop may not have enough scale, data quality or governance to be a true platform.
- Customer trust and privacy risks could weaken long-term loyalty.

THEORY APPLICATION

Platform/ecosystem perspective -> Lobyco could mediate value between suppliers and customers -> this creates possible multi-sided network logic -> strategic implication is to test whether Coop has enough scale, governance and trust. Digital Business Model value capture -> retail media can create supplier revenue -> but customer value must remain primary -> define guardrails.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Develop a retail media operating model with supplier criteria, customer relevance rules, privacy/trust safeguards and incremental-sales measurement.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

Supplier uptake, retail media revenue, customer consent/trust evidence, data governance, campaign attribution and platform scale benchmarks.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

Used: S1 Exam/case material for Coop/Lobyco relationship and financial need.

Not used: S2 DVC - reason: platform and value capture are more central than customer experience alone.

Not used: S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen - reason: historical IT context does not evidence current retail media platform viability.

Used: S4 Lobyco for retail media/app capability claims.

Used: S5 Playable for campaign and supplier-funded engagement claims.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

This angle must repeatedly say "could" and "claims". It should not call Lobyco a successful platform without independent evidence.

Lobyco Angle C: External Growth Versus Coop Dependency

Strategic question: Should Lobyco pursue external customers, or would that distract from Coop's immediate strategic needs?

HIGH EXAM RISK

POSSIBLE MAIN CLAIM

Lobyco should only pursue external growth if it can demonstrate that external product scaling strengthens, rather than distracts from, Coop's turnaround and app/store value.

SUPPORT EVIDENCE

- Lobyco is presented as a distinct digital capability.
- Historical Coop IT context can support a capability-building discussion.
- Digital business model theory can frame customer segments beyond Coop.

COUNTER / NUANCE

- The project currently lacks verified evidence on external clients, revenue or profitability.
- The exam case may penalize a paper that moves too far away from Coop Denmark.
- External growth may require resources Coop cannot spare under financial pressure.

THEORY APPLICATION

Digital Business Model customer segments -> Lobyco may serve Coop and external clients -> different segments create conflicting priorities -> strategic implication is mandate clarity. Resource-based view -> Lobyco could be valuable capability -> if it is not rare or profitable externally, external scaling is weak -> test capability distinctiveness.

LIKELY RECOMMENDATION TYPE

Set a decision gate for external growth: minimum external revenue, no degradation of Coop roadmap, clear product-market fit and transparent resource allocation.

ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE NEEDED

External client list, revenue, margins, market demand, product roadmap conflicts, staffing constraints and Coop strategic dependency.

FIVE-SOURCE USE

- **Used:** S1 Exam/case material for Coop ownership/context.
- **Not used:** S2 DVC - reason: external growth is a business model/capability issue, not primarily a customer experience issue.
- **Used:** S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen for historical capability context.
- **Used:** S4 Lobyco for self-presentation of capability and app reach.
- **Not used:** S5 Playable - reason: supplier campaign evidence does not establish external product-market fit.

SOURCE CRITICISM NOTES

This is the most speculative Lobyco angle. It should be used only if more evidence on external business potential is located.

Source-Use Table

This table shows how the five supplementary sources function across the possible angles. It does not replace final references or page-level citations.

SOURCE	MOST RELEVANT ANGLES	BEST USE	USE CAUTIOUSLY BECAUSE
S1 Exam/case material	All angles	Foundation for Coop's situation, financial pressure, store model, app/Lobyco context.	Numbers and exact claims still need exact wording and citation check.
S2 DVC Framework	Digital relevance, chain differentiation, store experience, Lobyco store-value engine.	Analyse experiences, relationships, relevance, infrastructure and outputs.	Can overemphasise positive digital value if used without source criticism and economic logic.
S3 Hedman & Bjorn-Andersen 2016	CEO portfolio, Lobyco capability, implementation-heavy angles.	Historical IT transformation and capability context.	Older source; not evidence for current app performance or present financial impact.
S4 Lobyco source	Most app, Lobyco, retail media and customer relationship angles.	Claims about reach, engagement, app value and Lobyco's role.	Commercially interested; adoption and engagement do not prove profitability.
S5 Playable source	Retail media, campaign, gamification and engagement angles.	Evidence of intended campaign/gamification value and supplier-funded possibilities.	Supplier marketing; campaign engagement is not long-term loyalty or profit evidence.
Shortcut	Only if separately located.	Could support app development and feature history.	Source missing/unverified in the five located supplementary PDFs; cannot be used as evidence until located.

Comparison Of Strongest Possible Angles

The strongest angles are not final choices. They are the angles that currently offer the best balance of case fit, theory application, source criticism and recommendation potential.

POSSIBLE ANGLE	WHY IT IS STRONG	BEST-FIT ACTOR	BEST-FIT THEORY	MAIN RISK BEFORE CHOOSING
Keep App/Lobyco, but govern it through store economics	Balances digital opportunity with Coop's financial pressure and physical-store model.	CEO / Digital Director	DVC + Digital Business Model	Needs internal evidence on store-level and financial contribution.
From app reach to customer relevance	Uses Lobyco claims without overclaiming them and applies DVC directly.	Director of Communication, Marketing and Digital	DVC + Digital Business Model	Can become too app-positive if profitability and source criticism are weak.
Differentiate app strategy by chain	Matches competitor evidence showing digital tools work when fitted to business model and chain promise.	Commercial Director / Digital Director	DVC + Porter/Positioning	Needs stronger Coop chain-specific evidence, not only competitor comparison.
Retail media with trust and KPI discipline	Connects Lobyco, suppliers, app users and possible new value capture.	Digital Director / Lobyco Leadership	Platform/Ecosystem + Digital Business Model	High marketing-source bias and uncertain customer trust effects.

POSSIBLE ANGLE	WHY IT IS STRONG	BEST-FIT ACTOR	BEST-FIT THEORY	MAIN RISK BEFORE CHOOSING
From engagement KPIs to economic KPIs	Creates a rigorous, source-critical paper under financial pressure.	CFO	Digital Business Model + Implementation	May become less rich on customer experience and digital value creation.

Open Decisions

These decisions should remain open until evidence is verified and the user chooses a final direction.

Executive to advise: strongest current candidates are Director of Communication, Marketing and Digital, CEO/top management and Commercial Director/chain management.

Theory choice: strongest current candidate is DVC + Digital Business Model; DVC + Porter/positioning becomes stronger if competitor/chain positioning dominates.

Strategic position: strongest current candidate is a hybrid position: keep Coop App/Lobyco, but tie investment to store economics, customer relevance and financial discipline.

Competitor focus: the strongest lens is digital fit with business model, not a broad competitor market report.

Missing Evidence

The report should not be turned into a final paper before these gaps are handled.

EVIDENCE GAP	WHY IT MATTERS	RELEVANT ANGLES
Exact case wording and references for financial numbers	Prevents mixing revenue, EBIT, EBITDA, net loss and exam-case figures.	CEO, CFO, portfolio and investment angles.
Internal app-user economic data	Needed to move from app adoption to profitability or store impact.	Digital relevance, CFO KPI, store traffic angles.
Retail media revenue and attribution evidence	Needed before arguing that supplier-funded value is strategically material.	Retail media, Lobyco platform, CEO hybrid angles.
Chain-specific Coop evidence	Needed to justify differentiated app strategy by chain.	Commercial chain, digital communication and price/simplicity angles.
Lobyco external-business evidence	Needed before treating Lobyco as growth platform or divestment candidate.	Lobyco external, CEO Lobyco mandate angles.
Original competitor source URLs and exact wording	Needed because the imported scrape synthesis is secondary.	Competitor, positioning and chain-differentiation angles.
Shortcut source verification	Shortcut is mentioned in evidence files but not found among the five located supplementary PDFs.	App development and implementation angles if Shortcut becomes relevant.